

attract some attention. In certain cases the actual value of the product might be way lower than what's shown in one of these deals. The product could even be defective, or worse, be a cheap knockoff. This is especially true in the case of electronics, where Chinese manufacturers copy the look and feel of a popular, branded device, and sell it with a description that might mislead you into believing that it is genuine.

How to deal

Before you place that order **Read through the policies**

Make sure that that your personal or contact information is not being sold to third parties without your consent, to avoid your inbox overflowing with spam. This generally happens when you're purchasing a massively discounted product, where the site tries to make up on lost revenue by selling your information to third parties. While signing up, make sure that you uncheck the option that signs you up for the company's promotional emailers, unless you're genuinely interested.

Understand the company's returns and replacement policies. Make a careful note of how the damages during shipment of products are handled. Try to look for sites that offer longer return periods and cover the return shipping costs. Some e-commerce sites even handle the return shipping themselves, letting you stay away from the hassles of finding a courier service.



Find out their contact information before placing the order

If something goes wrong after you place the order or even during the course of shipping, you should be able to get in touch with the seller via emails or phone calls. Most sites generally have their contact number and email prominently featured on their homepage. You could also contact the seller through social networking sites like Twitter and Facebook, where their accounts tend to be highly active and responsive. Apart from these media, most sites also have live chat customer support, or an online helpdesk, where you can open issues and track their progress.